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SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SOCKS, MEN'S, NYLON AND COTTON,

RIBBED, STRETCH TYPE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers a stretch-type dress sock with an elastic top.

1.2 Classification. The socks shall be of one type in the following classes and sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1 - Black 94
Class 2 - White 3018
Class 3 - Khaki 3719

Schedule of sizes

Small	-	(9, 9-1/2, 10)
Medium	-	(10-1/2, 11, 11-1/2)
Large	-	(12, 13)
Extra Large	-	(14, 15 and over)

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8440

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping
DDD-L-20	-	Label; For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191	-	Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams and Stitching

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publication. Unless otherwise specified, the following document of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.

3.1.1 Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variation from this document may appear in the sample, in which case this document shall govern.

3.1.2 Standard sample. The socks shall match the standard sample for shade and shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced (see 6.3).

3.1.3 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.4).

3.2 Material (see 6.5).

3.2.1 Knitting yarn. The knitting yarn shall be made by plying or twisting one end of the cotton yarn specified in 3.2.1.1 with one end of the nylon stretch yarn specified in 3.2.1.2 using 2 to 4 turns of twist per inch.

3.2.1.1 Cotton yarn. The yarn shall be a singles 60 ± 2 cotton count combed, mercerized or non-mercerized cotton yarn.

3.2.1.2 Nylon stretch yarn. The yarn shall be a stretch type nylon yarn processed from two ends of 70 denier (± 5 percent) nylon.

3.2.2 Elastic yarn. The elastic yarn for the cuff shall be 140 denier Spandex core having a 70 denier stretch type nylon inner and outer cover.

3.2.3 Looping yarn. The yarn for looping shall be as specified in 3.2.1.2.

3.2.4 Looper line yarn. The yarn for knitting the looper line shall be either the knitting yarn specified in 3.2.1 or 32/2 ± 2 counts, combed, mercerized or non-mercerized cotton yarn.

3.2.5 Seaming thread. The thread for seaming the toes of the socks shall be nylon, natural white, commercial size 4, 1 or 2 ply. The thread shall have a length of 96,000 yards per pound ± 5 percent, a minimum breaking strength of 0.35 pounds and a minimum elongation of 35 percent.

3.3 Label. Each sock shall have a size marking applied just below the rib knit instep and centered between the ankle and toe. The size marking shall conform to type III, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The color of the marking medium shall be white for the class 1 socks and black for the class 2 and 3 socks.

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The size marking shall be clearly legible and show good fastness to laundering transference (wool method). The legend and size of characters for each size sock shall be as follows:

Size	Legend	Minimum height of characters
Small	SMALL 9, 9-1/2, 10	5/16 inch
Medium	MEDIUM 10-1/2, 11, 11-1/2	5/16 inch
Large	LARGE 12, 13	5/16 inch
Extra Large	EXTRA LARGE 14, 15 and over	5/16 inch

3.4 Color. The color (class) of the finished socks shall be as specified (see 1.2 and 6.2). The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyestuff shall be chosen and applied so that the dyed and finished socks shall contain no more labile sulfur than shown by the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.4. When a standard sample is not available, the dyed and finished socks shall show no more than a slight trace of labile sulfur as defined in the test method specified in 4.4.4. For matching and colorfastness requirements, socks made with mercerized cotton yarns shall be compared with the standard sample made with mercerized cotton yarns. Socks made with non-mercerized cotton yarns shall be compared with the standard sample made with non-mercerized cotton yarns.

* 3.4.1 Matching. The color shall match the standard sample under artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7,000 ± 500 K and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2850 ± 100 K.

3.4.2 Colorfastness. The dyed socks shall show fastness to laundering equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the dyed socks shall show "good" fastness to laundering when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.5 Design. The socks shall be a seamless, circular ribbed knit, stretch type with a ribbed elastic top.

3.6 Construction.

3.6.1 Knitting. The socks shall be knit seamless in one integral unit on a 200 needle circular machine having a cylinder diameter of 3-1/2 inches.

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3.6.1.1 Leg and top of foot. The leg and top of foot as far as ring toe shall be a true 5 by 3 or 6 by 3 ribbed knit using one end of the knitting yarn specified in 3.2.1. Two 7 by 3 ribs shall be placed at the back of the sock when the 6 by 3 rib stitch is used.

3.6.1.2 Sole, heel, toe, and ring toe. The sole, heel, toe, and 1-inch ring toe shall be plain knit using one end of the knitting yarn specified in 3.2.1. A minimum of 26 gore needles shall be used in knitting the heel. A minimum of 26 gore needles shall be used in knitting the toe.

3.6.1.3 Looper line. The looper line (last knitted course around the toe closure opening) shall be knit with either of the yarns specified in 3.2.4. When the alternate cotton yarn is used, the looper line shall be accomplished as follows:

> On the reciprocation before the machine clutches out of toe, make yarn change introducing the cotton yarn in center of low butt sliders or toe section of sock. As the machine clutches out of toe, begin loose course with first active needle (first short butt) and continue for one revolution finishing at the first short butt.

3.6.1.4 Elastic top. The elastic top shall be a true 1 by 1 ribbed knit using one end of the knitting yarn specified in 3.2.1 with one end of the elastic yarn specified in 3.2.2 laid in every other course. The top edge shall be finished with a turn-over, well defined, non-raveling welt, free from loose ends.

3.6.2 Closing the toes. The toes shall be closed by looping as specified in 3.6.2.1 or by seaming as specified in 3.6.2.2.

3.6.2.1 Looped toes. The toes shall be closed with a looper using not less than two ends of the looping yarn specified in 3.2.3. The looping line shall be as elastic as the knit fabric and shall be smooth and free from lumps, laps, cuts and bruises.

3.6.2.2 Seamed toes. The toes shall be closed by seaming using the thread specified in 3.2.5. The seamed closure shall be as elastic as the knit fabric and shall be pulled flat to lie smooth and shall be free from lumps, laps, cuts and bruises. A thread chain of 1/4 to 1 inch shall be left at the ends of the stitching to prevent raveling.

3.6.2.2.1 Stitch and seam types. The stitch and seam types used shall conform to FED-STD-751. The stitch type shall be type 521. The toes shall be seamed inside out with the two edges of the opening superimposed in seam type SSa-1. The sock shall be turned right side out and the seam pulled flat and the edges of the toe opening shall abut as in seam type FSa-1.

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3.6.2.2.2 Stitches per inch. The seams shall be made with 50 to 56 stitches per inch using the nylon thread specified in 3.2.5 in both needles and looper. The stitches per inch requirement is based on the socks being in a relaxed state and shall be counted along the left hand row of needle penetrations, that is, the row toward the foot of the sock or away from the edge of the opening as the sock comes off the sewing machine. The sock may be marked off in the relaxed state and the toe stretched to facilitate easier counting.

3.6.3 Length of loose ends. All ends of yarn on the inside of the finished sock shall be trimmed to not less than 1/4 inch nor more than 1 inch.

3.6.4 Finishing. The socks shall be scoured, dyed and boarded on drying forms to their proper minimum size and length.

3.6.5 Pairing. The socks shall be matched and paired so that there will be no greater difference in foot length than 1/4 inch and in leg length 1/2 inch. Unless otherwise specified, the use of thread, twine, or staple to secure a pair of socks will not be permitted.

3.7 Physical requirements.

3.7.1 Measurements, courses, and weights. The measurements, courses, and weights of the finished socks shall conform to table I. All measurements in table I shall be made with the sock laid out flat under no tension. Testing shall be as specified in 4.4.4.

TABLE I. Measurements, courses, and weights

	See figure 1	Size				Tolerance
		Small	Medium	Large	Extra Large	
Leg:						
Number of courses 1/	D	224	224	224	224	Minimum
Length, inches	A	11	11	11	11	± 1/2
Foot:						
Number of courses 2/	E	168	216	264	312	Minimum
Length, inches	F	8-1/2	9-3/4	11-1/4	12-3/4	± 1/2

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TABLE I. Measurements, courses, and weights (cont'd)

	See figure 1	Size				Tolerance
		Small	Medium	Large	Extra Large	
Elastic top:						
Number of courses 3/	B	52	52	52	52	Minimum
Length, inches	B	1-3/4	1-3/4	1-3/4	1-3/4	± 1/4
Width, inches	C	2-1/4	2-1/4	2-1/4	2-1/4	± 1/4
Ring toe width, inches	G	1	1	1	1	Minimum
Conditioned weight per dozen pairs, ounces	-	10-1/2	11-3/4	13	14-1/4	Minimum

1/ Leg courses shall be counted from first short butt heel gore needle to bottom edge of elastic ribbed top.

2/ Foot courses shall be counted from first short butt toe gore needle to first butt heel gore needle.

3/ Top courses shall be counted from bottom edge of welt to joining line of leg fabric.

3.7.2 Stretch. The finished sock shall conform to the stretch requirements listed in table II when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

TABLE II. Stretch requirements for finished socks

	Size				Tolerance
	Small	Medium	Large	Extra Large	
Crosswise stretch, inches					
Leg 1/	8	8	8	8	Minimum
Foot 2/	8	8	8	8	Minimum
Elastic top 3/	8	8	8	8	Minimum
Lengthwise stretch, inches, foot	11	13	15	17	Minimum

1/ Measure across a point midway between the bottom of heel and bottom of elastic top.

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2/ Measure across a point midway between heel and toe.

3/ Measure across a point midway between top and bottom of elastic top.

3.7.3 Bursting strength. The leg fabric of the finished sock shall have a ball bursting strength of not less than 85 pounds when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.7.4 Nonfibrous material content. The starch and protein content including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material of the finished sock shall not exceed 2.0 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished socks shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.2 and 4.4.3. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

* 4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document, or applicable purchase document.

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* 4.4.1.1 Certification. Components listed below shall be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certificate of compliance with the indicated requirements.

Component	Requirement paragraph
Knitting yarn	3.2.1
Elastic yarn	3.2.2
Looping yarn	3.2.3
Looper line yarn	3.2.4
Seaming thread	3.2.5

4.4.2 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one sock. The sample unit shall be one sock. The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 4.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE III. End item visual defects

Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Any holes, runs, or dropped stitches, including holes in looping or seaming.	X	
Thin areas or mends.	X	
Welt omitted, cut, frayed, or raveled.	X	
Welt uneven or not clearly defined.		X
Poor looping or fashioning of heel and toe gores resulting in tight tension, lumps or dog-ears that will not level out.	X	
Less than two ends of looping yarn (applicable to looped toes).	X	
Loose or floated ends:		
Not trimmed as specified		X
Ends floating more than 1 inch inside of sock.		X
Any floated ends on outside of sock.	X	
Pattern of knit:		
Not as specified throughout entire sock.	X	
Sock not knitted as an integral unit.	X	
Ring toe omitted.	X	

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TABLE III. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Elastic yarn omitted or improperly inserted in top.	X	
Knitting yarn missing - body.	X	
Nonuniform in overall appearance, not well shaped.		X
Slubby yarn more than three times normal diameter.		X
Streaks, stains, shade bars, or spots, clearly noticeable. 1/		X
Rancid or bad odor.	X	
Off-shade or mismatch for shade.		X
Vegetable matter - clearly noticeable. 1/		X
Applicable to seamed toes:		
Wrong seam or stitch type.	X	
Thread chain less than 1/4 inch but not less than 1/8 inch.		X
Thread chain less than 1/8 inch.	X	
Thread chain more than 1 inch.		X
Ends of stitching more than 1 inch.		X
Ends of stitching less than 1/2 inch but not less than 1/4 inch, not chained off.		X
Ends of stitching less than 1/4 inch, not chained off.	X	
Skipped stitches, run-offs, or broken thread resulting in:		
a) Open seam up to 1/8 inch inclusive.		X
b) Open seam more than 1/8 inch.	X	
Edges of toe opening do not abut or are overlapped.		X
Seam not flat or smooth.		X
Boarded up.	X	
Stretch lacking (tight) or loosely knit (slack or sleezy).	X	
Burn or scorch in fabric.	X	
Label missing, incorrect, or illegible.		X

1/ At normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet).

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4.4.3 End item dimensional examination. The socks shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one sock. The sample unit shall be one sock and the selection shall be by pairs. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

Examine	Defect
Leg length	More or less than specified tolerance.
Foot length	More or less than specified tolerance.
Elastic top length	Less than specified.
Elastic top width	Less than specified.
Ring toe width	Less than specified.
Pairing	Mismated by more than 1/4 inch in foot length or 1/2 inch in leg length (tallied only for one sock in any pair)

4.4.4 End item testing. The socks shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table V. The test methods listed in table V shall be in accordance with FED-STD-191 except as otherwise noted, and as described herein. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the number of test specimens selected for a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test methods. When the data in the "Number of determinations per sample unit" and "Results reported as" columns are not specified in table V they shall be as required by the referenced test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one sock. Except as indicated below for weight and stretch determinations, the sample size shall be in accordance with table IV and the lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirement specified. The sample unit for test purposes shall be as follows:

Weight determination:	Twelve pairs of socks from each size represented. The sample size shall be one unit regardless of lot size.
Stretch determination:	Eight individual socks from each size in the lot. The sample size shall be one unit regardless of lot size.
All other test determinations:	Fifteen individual socks representing each size in the lot proportionately.

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TABLE IV. Sample size

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

TABLE V. End item tests

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Labile sulfur	3.4	2020	-	-
Colorfastness to laundering	3.4.2	5610 and 5614		
Type of knit	3.6.1.1 3.6.1.2 3.6.1.4	1/	-	-
Seamed toes, stitches per inch	3.6.2.2.2	Count	1	Actual count
Number of courses:				
Leg	3.7.1	Count	1	Nearest whole number
Foot	3.7.1	Count	1	Nearest whole number
Elastic top	3.7.1	Count	1	Nearest whole number
Weight per dozen pairs (conditioned)	3.7.1	Scale	1	To nearest 1/4 ounce
Crosswise stretch: Foot	3.7.2	2/	8	Average of 8 determinations to nearest 0.1 inch

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TABLE V. End item tests (cont'd)

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Crosswise stretch: (cont'd)				
Leg	3.7.2	2/	8	Average of 8 determinations to nearest 0.1 inch
Top	3.7.2	2/	8	Average of 8 determinations to nearest 0.1 inch
Lengthwise stretch, foot	3.7.2	3/	8	Average of 8 detemination to nearest 0.1 inch
Bursting strength	3.7.3	5120	-	-
Nonfibrous materials	3.7.4	2611	-	-

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.

2/ The stretch measurement shall be evaluated on a Houchin modification of a Schieffer machine described in Method 7540 of FED-STD-191. The sock shall be pulled over the form so that the 2-inch edges shall be parallel to the foot of the sock. The indicator pin shall be inserted in the upper 2-inch edge of the separating form and a 10-pound weight slowly applied so as to cause separation of upper and lower slotted form with resultant stretch of the sock under a uniform load over the 2-inch edges. After the weight has hung freely for 30 seconds, the distance between the upper and lower edges of the separated form shall be measured to the nearest 0.1 inch and recorded as the stretch of the sock.

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3/ The lengthwise stretch of the socks shall be measured using the apparatus and the procedure for measurement of specimen described in Method 7560 of FED-STD-191. The measurements shall be taken to the nearest 0.1 of an inch and the measured stretched "foot length" obtained in accordance with the procedure in Method 7560 shall be considered as the lengthwise foot stretch.

4.4.5 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing, and marking comply with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application. Size shown on socks not the same as on the containers. 1/
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of bundles per shipping container is more or less than specified. Number per bundle is more or less than required. 1/

1/ For this defect, one bundle shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

* 4.4.6 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.

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Examine	Defect
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pair of socks shall be folded at the heels in accordance with industry's practice. Twelve pairs of socks of one class and size only shall be neatly stacked in a bundle, with every other pair or every six pairs reversed, and securely tied at each end with cotton tape or twine.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. Socks shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. One hundred and twenty pairs of socks of one class and size only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A bundles shall be packed within a shipping container in two layers of five bundles each. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 16-1/2 inches in length, 11-1/2 inches in width, and 8-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5. Towards the end of the contract, or when there are less than the required amount per container of the same size, mixed sizes of one class may be packed within the same shipping container.

5.2.2 Level B packing. One hundred and twenty pairs of socks of one class and size only, preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF, (variety SW), or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class

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domestic, variety SW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Level A bundles shall be packed within a shipping container in two layers of five bundles each. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 16-1/2 inches in length, 11-1/2 inches in width, and 8-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5. Towards the end of the contract, or when there are less than the required amount per container of the same size, mixed sizes of one class may be packed within the same shipping container.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard container. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the box specification, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Socks, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), socks, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O and P. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

* 5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

* 5.4.1 Labels, mixed sizes. Each shipping container packed with mixed sizes, shall have securely attached to the end and side, directly under the printing or stenciling, a white paper label 5 by 4 inches with the words "MIXED NSN'S" plainly stamped or printed thereon and under these words shall be legibly stamped or printed the correct quantity and NSN's contained therein.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The socks are intended for use as dress wear by male military personnel.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

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a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Class and size required (see 1.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1.3, 4.3 and 6.4).
d. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Sample. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of 12 pairs of socks. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents, regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this document (see 3.2).

6.6 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modification, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

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Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8440-0161

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC
Air Force - 11, 82
DLA - CT

User activity:

Air Force - 45

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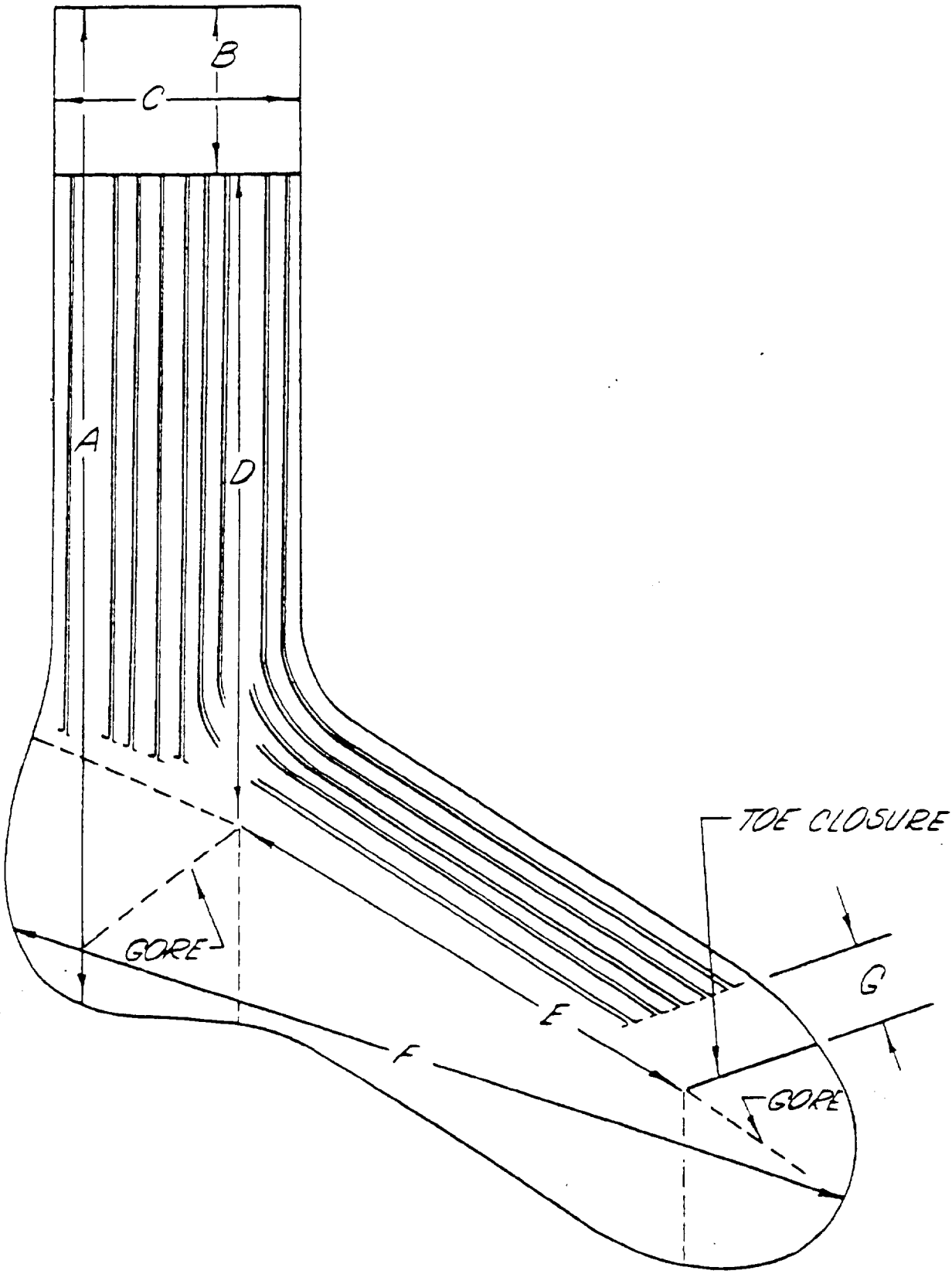


FIG. 1- SOCKS, MEN'S, NYLON AND COTTON, RIBBED, STRETCH-TYPE 2-1-98SA

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-12549H	Socks, Men's, Nylon and Cotton, Ribbed Stretch Type

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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